Sample SOP for an assistant or VA: when a deposit comes in

One task, written so an assistant can do it the same way every time.

Part of Train your team. Plain steps an assistant can follow without asking, written so someone whose first language isn't English can use them. This sample covers one task.

Why we do this

A deposit starts a lot of small jobs. Most mistakes happen when one of them is skipped, like a confirmation that stays in an email. These steps make sure every trip starts the same way.

Who owns what

The advisor owns every message to the client and the final OK. The assistant owns recording confirmations, insurance quotes and supplier claims.

Steps: when a deposit comes in

1. Open the trip in the CRM. Check the deposit shows as paid.
2. Find the confirmation from the supplier. Copy the confirmation number exactly.
3. Add the confirmation number in 3 places: the CRM trip, the itinerary, and the trip tracker.
4. Save the confirmation PDF to the trip. Use the name: Supplier - Confirmation - Date (example: Celebrity - 7319482 - 2027-03-02).
5. Check that the welcome email and traveler form went out. If either is still a draft, tell the advisor.
6. Get a travel insurance quote. Save it as a draft for the advisor.
7. If it's a cruise, claim the booking in the cruise line's agent portal within 3 days.
8. Move the trip to the next stage in the CRM. Leave a short note: what you did and what's still missing.

If something is missing, unclear, or doesn't match, stop and ask the advisor. Don't guess.